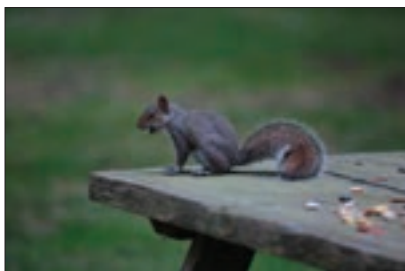


The *Digital Photography Manual* by Winn L. Rosch defines depth of field as *the range of distances that appears to be sharp or in focus in a photograph*. Greater depth of field means most of the scene in the frame has a high degree of sharpness. Both, the foreground as well as the background are in sharp focus.

A shallow depth of field allows a certain subject or selection (within the depth of field) to be in sharp focus while the rest of the scene appears less sharp or blurred.



The Av mode, therefore, gives a higher degree of control over the depth of focus of your photograph. You can set the aperture as required, depending on whether you're focusing on a particular object or person or trying to capture a natural scene. If set to a small aperture, a wide-angle lens, for example, would give you a nearly infinite depth of field. This is indispensable when it comes to photographing landscapes. A wide aperture, on the other hand, coupled with a longer lens, allows you to bring a particular object in the foreground into sharp focus. This setting would be ideal for portrait photography.

The aperture priority mode tells the camera how it should choose the shutter speed, minimising the risk of poor exposure or overexposure. Typically, while using Av mode, you should keep in mind that landscapes would need smaller apertures and portraits, larger ones.

The expert control of the aperture value is what transforms photography into an art. And to become that expert, you'll need to understand the *f* that you see on the LCD screen.

2.2 Aperture Size (f-number)

Lens apertures are usually measured as f-stops, denoted by f-numbers. You'll find it referred to in books and maga-